SECURITY

Incident Response Playbooks Visual Guide

Ransomware, breaches, takeovers — rehearsed step-flows for the worst days.

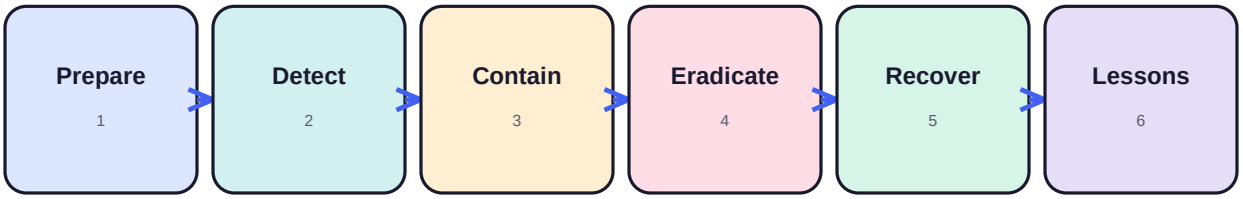
ANIMATED WALKTHROUGH

Step through pages to play the animation

STEP 1/6

The IR Lifecycle

Every incident rides the same six stages.



Preparation decides the outcome: contact lists, tooling access, and backups are built on quiet days — not during the fire.

STEP 2/6

Playbook: Ransomware

Speed of containment beats perfection of analysis.

- 1. ISOLATE affected hosts immediately (network, not power — preserve memory forensics).
- 2. Identify the variant and entry point; check backups are intact and OFFLINE.
- 3. Engage leadership + legal; decide on ransom policy BEFORE pressure peaks (default: don't pay).
- 4. Eradicate: rebuild from known-good images, rotate all credentials.
- 5. Recover in priority order; validate clean with EDR sweeps before reconnecting.

STEP 3/6

Playbook: Data Breach

Scope the exposure, protect the people affected.

- 1. CONTAIN the exfiltration path: revoke keys, block egress, preserve logs.
- 2. Scope: what data, whose, how many records — forensics determines this, not guesses.
- 3. Legal + privacy drive notifications: regulators and affected individuals on legal timelines.
- 4. Eradicate root cause; rotate everything the attacker could have touched.
- 5. Offer support to affected users; publish an honest post-mortem.

STEP 4/6

Playbook: Account Takeover

One compromised account can be a foothold — treat it that way.

- 1. LOCK the account and revoke all sessions/tokens immediately.
- 2. Timeline the attacker's actions: logins, password/MFA changes, data accessed.
- 3. Check for persistence: new MFA devices, forwarding rules, OAuth grants.
- 4. Reset credentials via a verified channel — never the possibly-compromised inbox.
- 5. Harden: phishing-resistant MFA, alert on impossible-travel logins.

STEP 5/6

Roles & Communication

Chaos is the real adversary — organization beats it.

Commander
decisions

Comms lead
one voice

Scribe
timeline log

War-room channel, 15-minute standups, single spokesperson. Log every decision with timestamps — memory lies, timelines don't.

STEP 6/6

After-Action: Lessons Learned

The incident isn't over when systems are back.

- Blameless review within two weeks: timeline, what worked, what failed.
- Every gap becomes a ticket with an owner and a date — or it will recur.
- Update the playbooks with what you learned; the next incident inherits the wisdom.
- Share sanitized lessons org-wide; security culture is built from real stories.

STEP ✓I✓

Key Takeaways

IR Playbooks — Remember

- All incidents follow: prepare → detect → contain → eradicate → recover → lessons.
- Ransomware: isolate fast, verify offline backups, rebuild from known-good.
- Breach: contain exfiltration, scope forensically, let legal drive notifications.
- Takeover: revoke sessions, hunt persistence, reset via verified channels.
- Assign commander, comms, scribe; run the war room on 15-minute cadence.
- Close with blameless review — every gap becomes an owned ticket.

Keep exploring

Pair this guide with the matching video walkthroughs
and hands-on labs at interstitiumlabs.dev